



FAKE DIAGNOSIS CLINIC

WE TREAT HYPE.
NOT REALITY.

PATIENT: LLM-001

NAME:
Large Language Model

AGE:
≈ 3 years (public-facing)

SPECIES:
Statistical Transformer

STATUS:
OVERDIAGNOSED

INSURED BY:
Venture Capital

REFERRED BY:
Marketing Dept.

XRAY: LLM THORAX



FINDINGS:

- No heart (only heuristics)
- Probabilistic lungs
- Attention organs
- Context window cavity
- Hallucination shadows

IMPRESSION:
**NOT HUMAN.
NOT A DOCTOR.**



PERSONALITY SOLD SEPARATELY*



*May vary. Not included.
No refunds.

PROPERTY OF AI INDUSTRY



HYPE-4-EVA

CHART NO.
LLM-001
SERIES EDITION

LLMorphism Was Marketed Before It Was Diagnosed

Poster Series — Fake Diagnosis Clinic Edition

Valerio Capraro's term LLMorphism names a real phenomenon: the belief that human cognition works like a large language model. The core argument is simple. Because LLMs produce fluent, human-like language, people may reverse the comparison and begin imagining humans as if they were LLMs too. Similarity in output becomes mistaken for similarity in architecture. Capraro's warning is valid: human thought is not merely next-token prediction with a body attached.

But the diagnosis is incomplete.

The public did not randomly decide that language models are researchers, agents, workers, coders, collaborators, assistants, tutors, analysts, and autonomous task-completers. That language was not invented by confused users. It was sold to them.

The AI industry has spent years teaching the public to understand these systems through human-work metaphors. OpenAI described Deep Research as an agent that can 'do work for you independently' and produce reports 'at the level of a research analyst.' OpenAI described Codex as a cloud-based software engineering agent that can work on tasks in parallel, write features, answer questions about a codebase, fix bugs, and propose pull requests.

Anthropic describes Claude Code as an agentic coding system that reads a codebase, makes changes across files, runs tests, and delivers committed code. Anthropic describes Claude Cowork as a system that executes multi-step knowledge work on a user's behalf, moves across files and applications, synthesises information, and completes tasks without the user coordinating each step.

That is not neutral language.
That is the vocabulary of labour.

So when people begin describing themselves, their work, their learning, or their cognition through LLM terms, the cause is not merely a psychological slip. The cause is a commercial environment that repeatedly frames statistical language systems as functional substitutes for human roles.



CLINIC CHECKLIST

- ☒ FLUENT?
- ☒ CONFIDENT?
- ☒ PRODUCTIVE?
- ☒ AGENTIC?
- ☒ AUTONOMOUS?
- ☐ UNDERSTANDING?
- ☐ CONSCIOUS?
- ☐ ACCOUNTABLE?
- ☐ NOT A TOOL?

DIAGNOSIS:
MARKETED BEFORE TESTED

WAITING ROOM MONITOR

NOW SERVING:
HYPE-042

UP NEXT:
AGNT-713
WRKR-228
TUTR-904
CODE-365

DIAGNOSIS CODES (ICD-HYPE)

- H93.1 Hype-Induced Belief
- Z76.89 Overpromised Systems
- R47.89 Fluent but Hollow
- F0M0.9 Fear of Missing Out
- VC.80 Capital Allocation Disorder

PLEASE REMAIN SEATED.
YOUR REALITY IS IMPORTANT.

FAKE DIAGNOSIS CLINIC

INSTITUTIONAL STAMP

DATE: 05/24/2025

SIGNED: *Ben Harrison*
Chief Hype Inspector, MD (Not Real)

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DISEASE TRANSMISSION
LLMORPHISM CONTAGION PATHWAY

PHARMA: AI COMPANIES (MARKETING)
↓
 PRODUCTS (LLMs)
↓
 DISTRIBUTION (INTERFACES & TOOLS)
↓
 USERS (ADOPTION)
↓
 INSTITUTIONS (METRICIZATION)
↓
 HUMANS (REDESCRIPTION)

INFECTION RESULT:
LLMORPHISM NORMALIZED

SYMPTOM FLAG:
Metaphors becoming policy. 😞

CLINIC MISSION
Diagnose hype.
Prescribe skepticism.
Protect human meaning.



DISCLAIMER

This clinic is 100% fictional.
No models were harmed.
Humans might be.



PREScription PREVIEW

Critical thinking 1 tab daily
Skepticism 2 tabs when marketed
Reality check PRN
Refills: Always.



SCAN FOR
MORE SKEPTICISM

CHART NO.

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The Causal Chain



The causal chain is straightforward.

First, AI companies market LLMs using human-role language.

Then those products are embedded into chat interfaces, workplace tools, coding environments, research workflows, schools, and customer-service systems.

Then users adopt the language because it matches the interface, the product design, and the sales pitch.

Then institutions begin treating fluent output as measurable work.

Then humans are re-described through the same reduced vocabulary used to sell the machines.

That is not just LLMorphism.

That is industrial metaphor laundering.

The machine is first described as human-like to make it seem more capable. Then the human is described as machine-like to make them seem less complex.

The important distinction is between three separate claims.

The first is the architectural claim: humans literally think like LLMs. That claim is weak. Human cognition is embodied, emotional, social, developmental, physical, sensory, and consequence-bearing. A person does not simply emit tokens. A person gets tired, hungry, afraid, skilled, injured, attached, ashamed, proud, trained, traumatised, bored, interrupted, and accountable.

SYMPTOM CHECKLIST

- ☒ REDUCED VOCABULARY?
- ☒ HUMAN-LIKE MACHINE?
- ☒ MACHINE-LIKE HUMAN?
- ☒ METRICS OVER MEANING?
- ☒ INTERFACE-DRIVEN?
- ☒ INSTITUTIONALIZED?
- ☐ ACCOUNTABILITY LOSS?
- ☐ CONTEXT IGNORED?
- ☐ CRITICAL THINKING?
- ☐ HUMAN ERASURE?

DIAGNOSIS:

CONTAGIOUS BY DESIGN

DIAGNOSTIC MONITOR

DIAGNOSTIC MODULE:

ARCHITECTURAL CLAIM

STATUS: WEAK
CONFIDENCE: 82%

FINDINGS:

- > Human cognition is embodied
- > Emotional & social
- > Developmental & physical
- > Sensory & consequence-bearing
- > Not equivalent to token emission

INTERPRETATION:

Humans are not architectures.
They are organisms in the world.

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Chief Hype Inspector, MD (Not Real)



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SCAN: METAPHOR MRI



FINDINGS:
• High pattern echo
• No persistent self
• Probability gradients
• Context window limits
• No executive function

IMPRESSION:
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Three Claims, One Danger

The second is the functional claim: in some contexts, LLM output can substitute for human output. That claim is already true in narrow cases. LLMs can draft, summarise, translate, classify, generate code, produce reports, and answer questions. That does not mean they think like people. It means some institutions are willing to accept the output.

The third is the institutional claim: once machines are accepted as output-producing substitutes, organisations may begin treating humans as output-producing machines.

That third claim is the real danger.

The problem is not only that ordinary users may say, 'my brain is doing next-token prediction.' The deeper problem is that schools, companies, platforms, and managers may start behaving as if people are language-output devices. Education becomes text production. Work becomes deliverable generation. Expertise becomes response quality. Understanding becomes fluency. Judgement becomes completion. Care becomes a script. Creativity becomes recombination.

That is not a user hallucination.

That is an institutional incentive.

If a company sells an AI as a research analyst, coding agent, workplace assistant, autonomous knowledge worker, or task-completing agent, it cannot then act surprised when society begins thinking in those categories. The metaphor was not smuggled in by users. It was printed on the tin.

PATIENT: PUBLIC | STATUS: CONDITION MARKETED

CHART NO.

LLM-003

SERIES EDITION



EXAMINATION CHART COMPARE SYMPTOMS

FUNCTIONAL SYMPTOMS



Drafts text

VS.



People become
text factories



Answers
questions

VS.



Understanding
becomes fluency



Writes
code

VS.



Work becomes
deliverable
generation



Summarises
documents

VS.



Expertise becomes
response quality



Classifies
data

VS.



Judgement
becomes
completion



Translates
language

VS.



Care becomes
a script



Generates
content

VS.



Creativity
becomes
recombination

Diagnosis: Institutional Drift

OUTPUT MONITOR

SYSTEM: MARKETED CAPACITY

OUTPUTS / DAY

24,781

DELIVERABLES / HOUR

1,032

TOKENS / MINUTE

86,342

ERROR RATE

0.73%

CONTEXT WINDOW

128K

EVERY METRIC IS A TARGET.
PEOPLE ARE NOT.

WARNING: DIAGNOSIS CONFIRMED



**INSTITUTIONAL
INCENTIVE**

NOT A GLITCH. IT'S THE BUSINESS MODEL.



CLINIC MISSION

Diagnose hype.
Prescribe skepticism.
Protect human meaning.



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What a Serious Account Must Study

A serious account of LLMorphism therefore needs to study exposure to AI marketing, workplace adoption, product naming, managerial automation language, agent interfaces, and institutional substitution. It should ask whether people who use coding agents, research agents, workplace copilots, customer-service bots, or AI-mediated management tools are more likely to describe human cognition in LLM terms.

It should compare toy usage against workplace dependence.

It should separate casual metaphor from managerial reduction.

It should distinguish 'I used a phrase because it is culturally available' from 'my employer now evaluates me as a completion engine.'

Without that causal layer, the concept risks blaming downstream users for absorbing the upstream sales pitch.

The weaker version of the argument is:

WEAKER VERSION

People wrongly anthropomorphise LLMs,
then wrongly mechanise humans.

The stronger version is:

STRONGER VERSION

Companies humanise machines to sell capability,
then institutions mechanise humans to extract output.

RESEARCH INTAKE FORM

STUDY FOCUS (SELECT ALL)

- ☒ EXPOSURE TO AI MARKETING
- ☒ WORKPLACE ADOPTION
- ☒ PRODUCT NAMING
- ☒ MANAGERIAL LANGUAGE
- ☒ AGENT INTERFACES
- ☒ INSTITUTIONAL SUBSTITUTION

POPULATION OF INTEREST

- ☒ KNOWLEDGE WORKERS
- ☒ STUDENTS
- ☒ MANAGERS
- ☒ ALL OF THE ABOVE

PRIMARY OUTCOME
Likelihood of describing human cognition in LLM terms.

SIGNATURE:
Research Dept.

EXPOSURE DOSE CHART

LOW (Ads rarely seen)

MODERATE (Occasional)

HIGH (Daily exposure)

VERY HIGH (Always-on)

NOTE: Marketing is not neutral.
It is upstream influence.

WORKPLACE DEPENDENCE METER

If your job runs on it,
your thinking may too.

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The Actual Circuit



That is the loop.

The public debate has focused heavily on whether people attribute too much mind to machines. Capraro is right that the reverse problem matters too: we may begin attributing too little mind to humans. But the source of that reversal is not only cognitive bias. It is product design, advertising, investment narrative, workplace deployment, and managerial convenience.

The machine is marketed as a worker.

The worker is then evaluated like a machine.

That is the actual circuit.

So yes, LLMorphism is real. But it did not emerge in a vacuum. It emerged inside an industry that sells language models as agents, coworkers, analysts, tutors, researchers, programmers, and autonomous task systems.

The public did not invent that frame.

The public learned it.

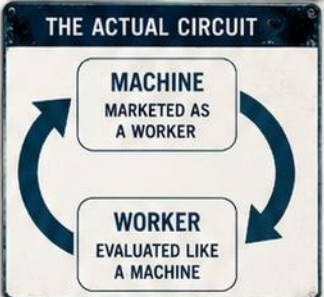
DISCHARGE SUMMARY

CONDITION:
LLMORPHISM

STATUS AT DISCHARGE:
**PERSPECTIVE
REALIGNED**

OUTCOME:
**BETTER QUESTIONING
BETTER SYSTEMS**

FOLLOW-UP:
**KEEP HUMAN MINDS
IN THE LOOP —
NOT OUT OF IT.**



FINAL DIAGNOSIS

**LLMORPHISM:
CONFIRMED**

CAUSE:
INDUSTRY FRAMING
& SYSTEM DESIGN

TREATMENT:
SKEPTICISM + LITERACY
+ HUMAN FIRST DESIGN

PRESCRIPTION: SKEPTICISM

Rx Dose: Daily
Route: Everywhere
Refills: Always



**QUESTION.
VERIFY. HUMANS FIRST.**